



Teesri Kasam: The Craftsman Shailendra - Complete English Explanation

1. Who Was Shailendra?

Shailendra was a highly renowned **lyricist** (गीतकार - one who writes songs for films) and **poet**. He wrote hundreds of songs for Hindi films throughout his career. What made him special was that he was not just a commercial songwriter, but a true poet with a very **sensitive heart** (संवेदनशील - soft, emotional). Shailendra was born on August 30, 1923, and died on December 14, 1966.

What was special about Shailendra:

- He always listened to his heart, not to money
- His songs focused on the lives and struggles of poor people
- He was an **idealist** (आदर्शवादी - someone who dreams of a perfect world)

2. What is the Film 'Teesri Kasam'?

"Teesri Kasam" is the name of a Hindi film that was made in **1966**. The film's story was based on a short story called "Mare Gaye Gulfam" (The Dead Circus Troupe) written by the famous author Phanishwar Nath Renu.

The film had:

- **Lead Actor:** Raj Kapoor (a famous and respected actor)
- **Lead Actress:** Waheeda Rehman
- **Director:** Basu Bhattacharya
- **Producer:** Shailendra (This was Shailendra's first and last film as a producer)

3. What is the Story of the Film?

The film tells the story of a man named Hiran from a village who drives a **bullock cart** (a cart pulled by oxen/bulls). The interesting part is that Hiran has to take **three oaths** (promise solemnly - कसम खानी) that he will not do certain things.

In the same village, there is a girl named Hirabai who performs in a theater group. A love story develops between Hiran and Hirabai, but their love cannot be fulfilled because **society does not allow them to be together**. Even though they love each other deeply, they are forced to separate.

4. The Friendship Between Shailendra and Raj Kapoor

Raj Kapoor was Shailendra's close friend. When Shailendra narrated the film's story to Raj Kapoor, the actor loved it immediately.

What happened next was remarkable:

- Raj Kapoor asked for only **one rupee** as his payment
- Then he jokingly said, "Give me this one rupee in advance right now"
- This meant Raj Kapoor was supporting Shailendra's dream without seeking profit

Shailendra had **no business sense** (understanding of commerce), but Raj Kapoor warned him that the film might fail commercially. However, Shailendra said he only wanted **satisfaction from his work**, not money. He wanted to make a film that was true to his artistic vision.

5. The Difficulties in Making the Film

Making the film faced many challenges:

- **Had to change filming locations** - Originally planned to shoot in Uttar Pradesh and Bihar, but due to fear of dacoits (robbers), they shifted to Madhya Pradesh
- **Severe budget overruns** - The money they had planned to spend ran out, and they needed more
- **Could not find distributors** - Nobody wanted to distribute the film to cinema halls; theater owners weren't interested
- **Production delays** - The shooting took much longer than expected

6. Why Did the Film Flop?

When the film was released, it was **pulled out of cinema halls within three days**. The film was a **commercial failure** (not profitable).

Reasons for its failure:

- The film had **no action sequences** - no fights, no drama, no sensational scenes
- The story was **simple and about poor, ordinary people** - commercial-minded people could not relate to it
- There was **no melodrama or glorification** (exaggeration) - no over-the-top emotions
- The story was **completely realistic and plain** - just showing ordinary life
- The songs and dialogues were **understated** (subtle, not dramatic)
- **The target audience wanted entertainment, not realism** - people wanted escapism, not to see their own lives on screen

Shailendra was so heartbroken by this failure that he **stopped writing songs** for a while, and he died a few years later.

7. Why Was the Film Called a "Poem on Celluloid"?

The author described the film as "**a poem written on celluloid**" (सेल्यूलॉइड पर लिखी कविता).

What this means:

- **Celluloid** = the film strip/reel used in movie cameras
- Calling the film a "poem" means - **it was as beautiful, emotional, and sensitive as poetry itself**
- Every scene (shot) in the film was like a verse from a poem
- The dialogues, songs, acting, and camera work - everything came from the heart of a poet
- The film was not made with commercial formulas, but with **poetic sensibility**

In other words, Shailendra created not just a film, but a **poetic creation** - a work of art.

8. What Were the Film's Qualities?

The special qualities of this "poem on celluloid":

- **Full of compassion** - deeply emotional and empathetic
- **Realistic** (यथार्थवादी) - it looked like real life
- **Sensitive** (संवेदनशील) - it touched people's hearts
- **Poignant** (करुणा से भरा - able to move people emotionally)
- **Deeply connected to life** - based on real human experiences
- **Honest** - it showed truth without embellishment
- **Subtle in its expression** - it didn't exaggerate pain or joy
- **Aesthetically pure** - not cheaply made or artificially constructed

The film neither **dramatized** (exaggerated) suffering nor was it **cheap or vulgar**. It simply showed **the real world in a gentle and honest way**.

9. What Awards Did the Film Win?

Later, when people finally understood the film's value, it won many prestigious awards:

- **President's Gold Medal** (National Film Award - India's highest film honor)
- **Best Film Award**
- **Best Director Award**
- **It was shown at the Moscow Film Festival** (one of the world's most important film festivals)

However, **this recognition came too late** - by the time the film was appreciated, Shailendra had already left this world. This is one of the great tragedies in Indian cinema history.

10. Shailendra's Qualities - His Personality as a Filmmaker

Shailendra as a film producer:

- **An idealistic, sensitive poet** - someone who dreamed big
- **Not motivated by wealth** - he wanted **self-satisfaction and artistic fulfillment** (आत्म-संतुष्टि)
- **Rejected false sophistication** - he stayed away from pretense (बनावटीपन)
- **Believed in truth** - he couldn't be pressured or influenced
- **Wanted to educate audiences** - he tried to improve people's taste in cinema
- **Had the patience of a true artist** - willing to invest years and money for quality

It's been said about him that he had the **"flow of a quiet river and the depth of an ocean"** - meaning he was calm on the surface but profoundly deep within.

11. What Makes This Chapter Important for Class 10?

This chapter teaches us several important lessons:

The Main Takeaway:

- **True art is not immediately understood by society**
- **Real artists value their vision more than commercial success**
- **Only a poet's heart can create something truly beautiful**
- **With time, genuine work always gets recognition**
- **Self-satisfaction and integrity are more valuable than profit**

12. Key Points to Remember for Exams:

Concept	Meaning
Shailendra	Lyricist, poet, and idealistic filmmaker
Teesri Kasam	A film that failed commercially but became a masterpiece
"Poem on Celluloid"	The film's poetic quality and artistic excellence
Raj Kapoor	Shailendra's friend who supported his dream
First and Last Film	It was Shailendra's only film as a producer
Commercial Failure	The film was pulled from theaters after 3 days
Later Recognition	Won National Film Awards and international acclaim

13. The Film's Impact on Indian Cinema

This film became important in Indian cinema history because:

- **It showed that cinema could be an art form, not just entertainment**
- **It proved that realistic, simple stories could be powerful**
- **It challenged the commercial cinema formula of that time**
- **It inspired future filmmakers to take artistic risks**
- **It became a reference point for artistic cinema in India**

14. Shailendra's Message Through This Film

The film ultimately communicates:

- ✓ **Authenticity matters** - showing truth is more important than showing spectacle
- ✓ **Art requires sacrifice** - the artist may suffer for their vision
- ✓ **Society grows slowly** - audiences eventually appreciate genuine art
- ✓ **Sensitivity is strength** - emotional depth is valuable
- ✓ **Following your heart pays off** - though not immediately, but eventually

Summary for Quick Revision:

Who? Shailendra - a poet-lyricist with an artistic vision

What? Teesri Kasam - his film masterpiece

Why it failed? People weren't ready for realistic, sensitive cinema

Why it matters? It showed cinema could be poetry and truth

Legacy? An immortal work that redefined Indian cinema

The Final Message: This chapter teaches us that real talent and genuine work may not succeed immediately, but they always leave an immortal mark on the world. Shailendra's Teesri Kasam is proof that **a true artist's creation transcends time and ultimately touches the hearts of generations.** ☐☐